AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

FirstRand Foundation / FNB × ASCO

Youth-Led Community Resilience and Sustainable Public-Benefit Action

Requested CSI investment: R150,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa; exact municipality/community to be confirmed with ASCO and selected using documented need, feasibility and alignment with the funder's geographic-representation principle.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **FirstRand Foundation / FNB** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth-Led Community Resilience and Sustainable Public-Benefit Action**. The proposed request is **R150,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Youth-Led Community Resilience and Sustainable Public-Benefit Action in South Africa; exact municipality/community to be confirmed with ASCO and selected using documented need, feasibility and alignment with the funder's geographic-representation principle., benefiting Proposed: young people and surrounding community members in an underserved South African community, with intentional inclusion of women, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups; final demographic mix and the portal's greater-than-85%-black beneficiary requirement must be verified before submission. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with FirstRand Foundation / FNB's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R150,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Youth-Led Community Resilience and Sustainable Public-Benefit Action

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa; exact municipality/community to be confirmed with ASCO and selected using documented need, feasibility and alignment with the funder's geographic-representation principle.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: young people and surrounding community members in an underserved South African community, with intentional inclusion of women, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups; final demographic mix and the portal's greater-than-85%-black beneficiary requirement must be verified before submission.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: engage 60 young people in structured civic and community-development participation over 6–9 months.
- Proposed: deliver 6 practical workshops on public-benefit project design, financial literacy/wellbeing, environmental sustainability and community leadership.
- Proposed: co-design and complete 3 small, locally prioritised sustainable public-benefit actions with youth and community representatives.
- Proposed: train 10 youth peer facilitators and provide simple toolkits so activities can continue after the grant period.
- Proposed: document baseline, attendance, demographics, outputs, beneficiary feedback and a close-out report suitable for funder reporting; these are targets, not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why FirstRand Foundation / FNB?

ASCO's proposed community development, youth participation and sustainable public-benefit activities could cautiously align with FirstRand Foundation priorities on thriving/resilient communities, capacity building, social cohesion, financial inclusion/wellbeing and potentially youth skills or participation. A proposal should define a South African community need, measurable public benefit, youth-led participation, sustainability beyond the grant and beneficiary demographics, while mapping activities to one or more published focus areas. This is a prospective alignment only; no partnership, approval or funding commitment is established.

Verified company context

- The FirstRand Foundation is the group vehicle through which FirstRand and customer-facing businesses including FNB direct CSI; its stated vision is fair access to economic opportunities and participation in South Africa's growth.
- FirstRand Foundation focus areas include building thriving and resilient communities; quality education for children aged 4–13; capacity building; and financial inclusion and wellbeing.
- The community focus explicitly includes initiatives connected to the creative economy, sport, green economy, disaster relief and social cohesion.
- The 2024 CSI report says interventions address poverty, inequality and unemployment and should represent race, disability, age, gender and geography; it also identifies partnerships, volunteer activity and technology as enablers.
- The official grant portal says eligible applicants include South African-registered juristic persons that are public-benefit organisations or otherwise meet the listed Income Tax Act public-benefit criteria, and whose initiatives align with strategic focus areas and benefit a majority (greater than 85%) of black people.
- The official grant process is eligibility check, account creation and profile registration, assessment/approval, grant search, application submission and status tracking; available grants are searched through the portal rather than assumed to be continuously open.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R90,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R12,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R9,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R12,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R10,500	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R10,500	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R6,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R150,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R150,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Primary official route: FirstRand Foundations grant portal at https://www.grantapplication.firstrand.co.za/Home/About; eligibility: https://www.grantapplication.firstrand.co.za/Home/WhoCanApply; portal contact: social.investing@firstrand.co.za. Secondary FNB route: official sponsorship lead form https://www.fnb.co.za/leadforms/sponsorships-lead-form.html?area=sponsorships (the form identifies sponsorship@fnb.co.za as recipient). ASCO's supplied contact is +27 76 757 5773 and https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- The portal's eligibility language includes South African registration, public-benefit status, strategic alignment and benefit to more than 85% black people; ASCO should confirm documentary compliance and whether its proposed beneficiaries satisfy these criteria before applying.
- No specific open grant call, award probability, minimum or maximum grant size, or deadline was established from the reviewed official pages; the portal indicates that applicants search available grants after registration and profile assessment.
- The published focus areas do not guarantee support for a general civic programme; the proposal should demonstrate a direct fit to community resilience, capacity building, social cohesion, youth skills/participation or financial wellbeing and avoid implying FNB/FirstRand endorsement.
- Do not claim Section 18A approval, completed project results, existing partnerships or any FirstRand/FNB commitment. Confirm reporting, safeguarding, monitoring, budget and procurement requirements directly with the foundation before submission.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **FirstRand Foundation / FNB** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.firstrand.co.za/foundations/firstrand-foundation/
2. https://www.firstrand.co.za/media/investors/societal/firstrand-corporate-social-investing-2024.pdf
3. https://www.firstrand.co.za/media/investors/reports/FirstRand-report-to-society-2023.pdf
4. https://www.grantapplication.firstrand.co.za/Home/About
5. https://www.grantapplication.firstrand.co.za/Home/WhoCanApply
6. https://www.fnb.co.za/about-fnb/csi/social-responsibility.html
7. https://www.fnb.co.za/leadforms/sponsorships-lead-form.html?area=sponsorships

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.